Hustle Hive CIC – Equality, Diversity and Inclusion Policy

Item	Detail
Organisation	Hustle Hive CIC, company no. 16691281
Policy lead	Kieron Davis, Director
Version	2.0
Effective from	October 2026
Next review	September 2027, or sooner if the law or our activities change

1. Our commitment

Hustle Hive CIC exists to help people of all ages build confidence, skills and opportunities through hands-on learning and enterprise. We want everyone who uses or delivers our services to be treated with dignity and respect, take part fully and safely, and feel they belong, whatever their background or circumstances.

Many of the people we work with face barriers, including educational disadvantage, disability, poverty, social exclusion and discrimination. We actively work to reduce these barriers and make our provision fair and accessible.

2. Scope

This policy applies to learners and participants of all ages, parents and carers, directors, staff, volunteers, contractors, partners and visitors. It covers all our activities: alternative provision, holiday clubs, Maker Days, workshops, adult programmes such as Makers to Market, off-site and online activities, recruitment and employment, and our work with schools, commissioners and funders.

3. The law

We follow the Equality Act 2010. It protects people from discrimination because of nine protected characteristics: age, disability, gender reassignment, marriage and civil partnership, pregnancy and maternity, race, religion or belief, sex, and sexual orientation.

We will not discriminate directly or indirectly, harass or victimise anyone because of a protected characteristic. We also make reasonable adjustments so that disabled people are not put at a disadvantage. We also aim to treat people fairly whatever their social or economic background, caring responsibilities, care experience or where they live, even though these are not protected characteristics.

4. What we mean

- **Equality:** making sure people are treated fairly and have equal access to opportunities. This does not always mean treating everyone the same; sometimes it means giving different support.
- **Diversity:** recognising and valuing the differences between people.
- **Inclusion:** creating an environment where everyone feels welcome, supported and able to take part.

5. Our aims

We aim to:

- give everyone fair access to our programmes;
- remove barriers to taking part;
- support people who are disadvantaged or vulnerable;
- challenge prejudice, stereotypes and discrimination;
- build good relationships between people from different backgrounds; and
- create a culture of respect and belonging.

6. Learners and participants

Fair access

We decide who can take part based on our programmes' published criteria and whether we can meet the person's needs safely, never on a protected characteristic. We will only refuse or limit a place on safety grounds after exploring reasonable adjustments with the person, their family and any referring school, and we record the reasons.

Reasonable adjustments

We ask about access and support needs at booking, referral or admission, and agree adjustments before someone starts. Examples include:

- adapting tasks, equipment or the pace of learning;
- extra breaks, a quiet space or a calmer time of day;
- materials in larger print, simple language or visual formats, and dyslexia-friendly resources;
- extra staff support for practical activities; and
- adjusted arrival or finish times.

Special educational needs and disabilities (SEND)

Many of our learners have SEND. We work with families and referring schools to understand each learner's needs, follow any EHCP or support plan we are given, adapt our teaching, and seek specialist advice where needed. Individual risk assessments include the adjustments a learner needs so they can use equipment safely.

Behaviour

Our Behaviour and Positive Conduct Policy applies to everyone, but we apply it fairly, taking account of disability, communication needs, trauma and culture. We monitor behaviour records to check that no group of learners is being treated less favourably.

Bullying, harassment and prejudice

Bullying, harassment and prejudice-based behaviour, including racist, sexist, homophobic, transphobic and disability-related abuse, are never acceptable. Staff challenge it straight away, support the person affected, help the person responsible understand the impact of what they did, and record the incident. Serious incidents are reported to parents, carers and schools, and handled under our Safeguarding policy where there is a risk of harm.

Culture and religion

Where reasonably possible, we accommodate cultural and religious needs, including dietary requirements, prayer, dress and important dates. We make sure religious dress and jewellery can be worn safely in the workshop, for example by agreeing safe adjustments rather than banning them.

Gender identity

We treat everyone with respect and dignity. For adults, we use the name and pronouns they ask us to. For children and young people, we follow the approach set out in section 12 of our Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy: we involve parents or carers and the referring school, make decisions case by case in the child's best interests, and follow current Department for Education guidance.

7. Staff and volunteers

Recruitment and employment

We recruit, select, train and promote staff and volunteers fairly, based on the skills and experience the role needs and safer recruitment requirements, in line with our Safer Recruitment Policy. We make reasonable adjustments for disabled applicants and staff, and welcome applications from people of all backgrounds.

Training

All staff and volunteers learn about this policy during induction, including how to make reasonable adjustments and how to challenge discrimination. Equality is included in our annual training.

8. Accessibility

We aim to make our premises, materials, website and communications as accessible as we reasonably can. We give clear information about access to our premises before people visit, so they can plan, and we discuss any barriers with them. Where we use other venues for activities or visits, we check access in advance.

We try to keep cost from being a barrier to taking part, and look for funding to support people who could not otherwise join our programmes.

9. Working with partners

We work with schools, families, commissioners, funders and other organisations to promote equality and inclusion. We expect contractors and partners delivering activities with us to follow this policy.

10. Reporting discrimination

Anyone who experiences or sees discrimination, harassment or unfair treatment should tell a member of staff or contact a Director. We will take every report seriously, look into it promptly and tell the person what we have done. If the concern involves a risk of harm to a child or adult at risk, we follow our Safeguarding policy. Staff can also raise concerns under our Whistleblowing Policy. No one will be treated unfairly for raising a concern in good faith.

11. Responsibilities

Who	Responsibilities
Directors	Make sure this policy is followed and resourced, and review equality information every year
Kieron Davis, policy lead	Leads on equality and accessibility; reviews reports of discrimination and monitoring information
All staff and volunteers	Follow this policy, make reasonable adjustments, challenge discrimination and report concerns
Learners and participants	Treat others with respect and follow our behaviour expectations

12. Monitoring and review

We ask participants to tell us about protected characteristics on an optional, confidential basis, and use this anonymously to check that our programmes are reaching and serving everyone fairly. Every year, the Directors review this information alongside feedback, complaints, bullying and behaviour records, and use what they find to improve our work. This also helps us report to funders and commissioners.

This policy is reviewed every year, and sooner if the law, our activities or our learners' needs change.

Related policies

Read this policy alongside our Safeguarding and Child Protection, Behaviour and Positive Conduct, Safer Recruitment, Medical Needs and Medicines, Whistleblowing and Data Protection policies, and our staff code of conduct.

Approval and signatures

This policy has been approved by the Board of Directors of Hustle Hive CIC.

Name	Position	Signature	Date
Gavin Copland	Director		
Kieron Davis	Director		
Carey Viala	Director		
Sarah Smith	Director		